

BUILDING FROM SCRATCH



UDAY KOTAK HAS GROWN KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK INTO ONE OF INDIA'S LARGEST FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS

- 1985** Uday Kotak started his entrepreneurial journey in bill discounting
- 1990** Forayed into auto financing
- 1991** Entered into lucrative investment banking business
- 1992** Kotak Mahindra Finance tapped IPO market
- 1998** Started mutual fund journey to pool the savings of small investors
- 2000** Plunged into the life insurance business
- 2001** Started the securities business to offer equity and debt



CEOs of private banks who were also promoters. Beginning in 2013, RBI required promoters to reduce their stake to 20% within 10 years of setting up a bank and to 15% within 12 years.

By 2020, Kotak and the RBI settled the issue amicably. However, in April 2021, when RBI decided to restrict MD & CEO tenures to 12 years, with a three-

year extension at its discretion, it became clear that Kotak would not be eligible for an extension beyond December 2023. Kotak stepped down on September 1, 2023, a few months before his term was scheduled to end, citing his son's wedding, and the need to give time to Joint MD Dipak Gupta to run the show as interim CEO till he retired in December, when Prakash Apte

was also due to retire as Chairman.

But, before stepping down, he went about with the "Amazonisation" of the bank, to make it a technology-centric and customer-first business. The new strategy was built upon three pillars: to provide an experience similar to that of Amazon, to improve the employee experience by giving them the necessary tools and systems, and to